

PHILIPS HTS3000

This is a model for the masses. A 5.1 home theatre system, this one sure packs a mean punch. At 94W RMS, it is not an earth-shaker, but is enough for a small living room. The system looks nice and has an external amplifier with a 5.1 Audio output, PC/VCD/CD input and 5.1 inputs.

Bundled is a remote control that handles individual speaker controls. However, the feature that will attract shoppers is the ability to handle almost any disk format, including SACDs and DivX CDs or DVDs in addition to playing regular DVDs, VCDs and MP3 disks.

This product is priced at a sweet Rs 9,990, which is enough to tempt any shopper to get one. Compared to other brands in the same price category, this system takes the cake, considering the features and performance. If you're on a limited budget and looking for a reputable system, your search ends right here!

**SAMSUNG HT-P50**

For a user with a budget of around Rs 35,000, we recommend the Samsung HT-P50 home theatre system. This system has all the frills that you can think of and also includes a USB port for connecting any USB devices and playing content directly from the system. It also features an FM tuner for when you just want to listen to radio. The media this system can play includes DVD Video, DVD Audio, DVD-R (W), CD-R (W), JPEG, MP3, WMA and DivX disks.

The form factor is extremely classy, with four satellite speakers and one central speaker and subwoofer. The USB port lets you connect your portable MP3 player and use it as a part of your home theatre system. You can now listen to your MP3s in 5.1 surround!

Inputs include auxiliary, an optical digital input and the USB port. Outputs include a SCART socket and composite video output, making it ready for HDTV as well as regular TVs.

The system has ample power and peaks at 1000 W RMS, enough for you to make yourself heard across your building!

At a price of Rs 34,400 the Samsung HT-P50 does not pinch your pocket too much, and does provide you with a fashionable home theatre and powerful features to boot.

**SONY DAV-LF1**

Let's get one thing out of the way first: this is a high-end system and costs Rs 99,990. Still interested? Read on...

The highlight of this system is that it is wireless. Yes, now no more wires to disrupt your interiors—well, almost. The DAV-LF1 still needs a power cord from one of the rear speakers and another main cord connecting it to the other. The other speakers require wires as usual. Just place them where you want, configure the system, and start watching movies and listening to music.

The system is powered modestly enough at 600 W RMS. However, it is the drop-dead gorgeous looks of this system that will attract you more than anything else.

There are four ultra-thin column speakers with one centre satellite speaker. You also have two wireless satellite speakers that can be hung on the wall right beside the centre channel. The subwoofer build quality is solid and is sure to shock and awe your neighbours at peak volume.

This may be a pricey system, but hey, if you want to complement your plasma or projection TV, you just can't go wrong with this baby!

